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Resurrection of Christ
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*"I was found by those who did not ask for Me;
I was sought by those who did not seek Me"
(Isa. 65:1).*



The conversation of our Lord Jesus Christ with the Samaritan woman, recounted in the fourth chapter of the Gospel of John, serves as the most vivid confirmation of the truth of these Divine words.

The Lord Jesus Christ was resting by Jacob's Well, near the Samaritan city of Sychar, while traveling a long journey from

Jerusalem to Galilee. A Samaritan woman approached the well with a water jar to draw water. The Lord asked her to give Him a drink.

The Samaritan woman was astonished by this request, for she recognized in the One asking for water a member of the Jewish people—who have no dealings with the Samaritans—and she asked: "How is it that you, being a Jew, ask a drink from me, a Samaritan woman?" (John 4:9). The Lord Jesus's reply astounded her: "If you knew the gift of God, and Who it is who says to you, 'Give Me a drink,' you would have asked Him, and He would have given you living water" (John 4:10).

Christ was speaking, of course, of that water of immortality which is celebrated in the Kontakion for the Feast of the Mid-Pentecost. But the Samaritan woman could not have known this; she was thinking only of fresh spring water—water possessing the miraculous property of quenching thirst forever.

Her astonishment reaches its climax when the Lord Jesus reveals His Divine omniscience, telling her that she has had five husbands, and that the man she currently has is not her husband. Her spiritual eyes are opened wide, and she perceives in her Interlocutor not merely an ordinary man, but a prophet. With such a great Man, one must speak of the loftiest questions of religion; thus, she asks Him to say who is right: the Jews, who worship God in the Temple in Jerusalem, or they—the Samaritans—who worship Him on Mount Gerizim.

The Lord Jesus Christ answered her with extraordinary words regarding the worship of God in Spirit and in truth, and He concluded His profound conversation with the Samaritan woman by explicitly declaring Himself to be the Messiah—the Christ.

Both at the beginning and in the midst of her conversation with the Lord Jesus Christ, the Samaritan woman, of course, did not look for the Messiah—the Christ—in her interlocutor; rather,

**Sunday, May 10, 2026
Divine Liturgy Sundays at 9:30 AM
Confessions before Liturgy
Coffee Hour after Liturgy – bring a snack to share**

**Sunday of the Samaritan Woman
О Самаряныне**

He revealed Himself to her, even though she had not inquired of Him as the Messiah. Deeply stirred by her conversation with the Lord Jesus Christ, the Samaritan woman left her water jar behind and hastened to Sychar to tell its inhabitants about the extraordinary Jewish passerby who knew all the deeds of her life and had declared Himself to be the Messiah—the Christ. She urged her fellow citizens to go and see for themselves whether He might be the Christ.

And it was not upon the Samaritans alone that the great words of the Prophet Isaiah were fulfilled: "I was found by those who did not seek Me; I was revealed to those who did not ask for Me..." (Archbishop Luke [Voyno-Yasenetsky])

Happy Mothers Day!

***On this Mothers Day we
all have an opportunity to
think back on the lessons
taught us by our mothers
and be grateful for their
nurturing love and guidance.
We show our love and
gratitude by the way we live
our lives***

Многая Лета

Вечная Память

***to all our mothers on this
day!***

Презвание к вере

Знаю, что придет Мессия, то есть Христос, когда Он придет, то возвестит нам все. Иисус говорит ей: Это Я, Который говорю с тобою (Ин 4, 25-26).

На этих словах Иисуса Христа хочу остановить внимание ваше. Впервые за всю Свою земную жизнь Он прямо сказал человеку, что Он есть Мессия. Я Христос, -- Я, говорящий с тобою. Народу избранному израильскому Он никогда не говорил, что Он Мессия, а в беседе с самарянкой впервые сказал. Как пойдем мы это?

Самарянка, пораженная этими словами, побежала в город и говорила всем людям: *Пойдите, посмотрите Человека, Который сказал мне все, что я сделала: не Он ли Христос?* (Ин 4,29). Вот видите, что случилось: Господь обратил к вере в Него, к вере христианской тех самарян, которых презирали иудеи. Христос первыми призвал к вере тех, кого считали отверженными.

Вот видите, из всех народов найдет овец стада Своего Господь наш Иисус Христос. Кто будет овцами стада Его? Только смиренные, только сокрушенные сердцем, трепещущие перед словом Его, как это говорит святой пророк Исаия.

Относится ли это только к отдельным людям, к каждому из нас? Не надо ли сказать, что требование Христово относится к целым народам, среди которых бывают и гордые, далекие от смирения народы, превозносящиеся над другими народами, жаждущие власти над всем миром, жаждущие сокровищ всего мира и творящие ради этого ужасающие злодеяния... где слабых и беззащитных угнетают и жестоко эксплуатируют сильные народы. *(Свят. Лука Крымский)*



The Samaritan Woman

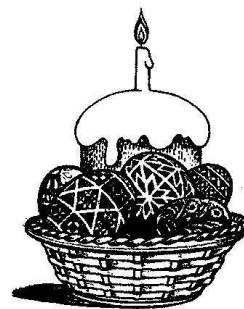
On this Sunday after Pascha, the Church remembers the conversation of Christ with the Samaritan Woman at Jacob's well. She is remembered in the Holy Church as Photina (in Russian Svetlana), and her memory is also commemorated on April 2 (n.s.)

"A woman came." She is a symbol of the Church not yet made righteous but about to be so. She was a Samaritan, a people who were foreigners to the Jews. The fact that she came from a foreign people is part of the symbolic meaning, for she is a symbol of the Church, which was to come from the Gentiles, a different race from the Jews.

Christ asks her for a drink, and He promises a drink. He is in need, as One hoping to receive, yet He is rich, as One about to satisfy the thirst of others. He speaks to her in veiled language and gradually enters into her heart. Or is He already teaching her? What could be more gentle and kind than the encouragement He gives: "If you knew the gift of God, and who It is that is saying to you, 'Give Me a drink,' perhaps you might ask and He would give you living water.

Christ was promising the Holy Spirit in satisfying abundance. The woman did not yet understand; in her failure to grasp His meaning, her reply was, "Master, give me this drink, so that I may feel no thirst or come here to draw water."

What is this water that He will give, if not the water spoken of in Scripture: "With Thee is the Fountain of Life"? How can those feel thirst, who "will drink deeply from the abundance in Thy house. *(excerpted from a homily by Blessed Augustine of Hippo)*



UPCOMING FEASTDAY

Thursday, May 21, 2026

ASCENSION / ВОЗНЕСЕНИЕ

Divine Liturgy / Литургия 9:30 AM Thursday
Vespers, Wednesday evening May 20 6:30 PM